Past simple: what Murphy does not tell you

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red, Unit 11 (pages 32–33): the form and the examples. Do **11.1, 11.2** in class, **11.3** at home. Unit 12 (page 35): **12.1** (didn't) in class. Questions with *Did...?* come next week.
This file adds five things the book does not explain.

1 · Three sounds of -ed (the book only says "-ed")

/t/ worked · watched · helped · cooked · jumped | **/d/** played · cleaned · called · listened · opened | **/ɪd/** wanted · needed · started · visited · decided
The ending is a **separate syllable only after t and d**: want-ed, need-ed. Everywhere else it is short: worked (one syllable).

2 · Spelling: the rules in one box

ends in **-e**: add -d → dance → danced · like → liked · live → lived
consonant + **y** → -ied → study → studied · try → tried · carry → carried *(but play → played, enjoy → enjoyed)*
short word, one vowel + one consonant: **double it** → stop → stopped · plan → planned
(but visit → visited, open → opened: the stress is not on the last syllable)

3 · Telling what happened: the order words

First, ... · **Then** ... · **After that** ... · **Next** ... · **Later** ... · **Suddenly** ... · **In the end** ...
First he opened the door. Then he looked inside. Suddenly he heard a noise. In the end he closed the door.

A comma after First / After that / Suddenly / In the end.

4 · Time words with the past

yesterday · **last** night / week / year · two days **ago** · **in** 1928 · **in** July · **on** Monday · **at** six o'clock

No in / on / at before yesterday, last and ago: ~~in last year~~ → last year.

5 · The Russian trap

«Я делал уроки» and «Я сделал уроки» are two different forms in Russian. English past simple has **one** form for both: *I did my homework.* To show that you finished: *I finished my homework.*
Never two pasts: ✗ I ~~didn't went~~ → ✓ I didn't **go**. ✗ I ~~did went~~.

After didn't: the verb has no ending and no change.

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 Sort the verbs by the sound of -ed: /t/ · /d/ · /ɪd/

watched · played · wanted · helped · cleaned · needed · jumped · opened · started · cooked · called · decided

/t/	/d/	/ɪd/

2 Write the past simple (watch the spelling)

1 dance → _____
2 study → _____
3 stop → _____
4 play → _____
5 plan → _____
6 try → _____
7 visit → _____
8 like → _____
9 carry → _____
10 open → _____
11 enjoy → _____
12 live → _____

3 Translate into English

1. Вчера мы работали в лаборатории.

2. Он не открыл дверь.

3. Я позвонил другу, но он не ответил.

4. Она посмотрела на меня и засмеялась.

5. Сначала он помыл руки, потом открыл дверь.

6. Мы не готовили вчера.

7. Они остановились и послушали.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 What happened in the lab? Look and write



Write 6 sentences about the picture, positive and negative: *The girl opened the door. The boy didn't smile.* Use: open · shout · laugh · smell · look · stop · not clean · not wait.

5 Complete the story: past simple, positive or negative

Last Saturday I (1 visit) _____ my uncle, a chemist. He (2 work) _____ in a laboratory, and I (3 want) _____ to see it. I (4 not touch) _____ anything, because he (5 show) _____ me the rules first. We (6 mix) _____ two chemicals carefully. Suddenly the mixture (7 change) _____ color, but it (8 not explode) _____. My uncle (9 laugh) _____ and I (10 not stop) _____ smiling all day.

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 /t/ watched · helped · jumped · cooked /d/ played · cleaned · opened · called /ɪd/ wanted · needed · started · decided

2 danced · studied · stopped · played · planned · tried · visited · liked · carried · opened · enjoyed · lived

3 We worked in the laboratory yesterday. · He didn’t open the door. · I called my friend, but he didn’t reply. · She looked at me and laughed. · First he washed his hands. Then he opened the door. · We didn’t cook yesterday. · They stopped and listened.

4 Possible: The girl opened the door. The boy shouted. The teacher looked at the smoke. They smelled something terrible. The girl didn’t clean the table. They didn’t wait.

5 visited · worked · wanted · didn’t touch · showed · mixed · changed · didn’t explode · laughed · didn’t stop